



Grasses and grains

Grasses produce the grains that feed the world. Grasses with edible seeds or grains are known as cereal plants and have been cultivated for thousands of years. Today, cereals are harvested on a massive scale around the world.

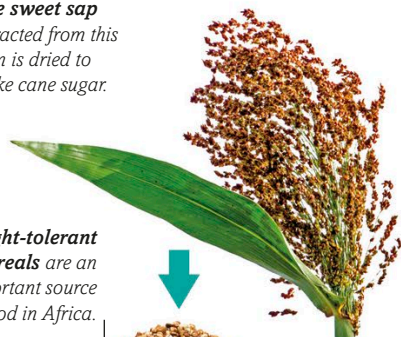


Sugarcane

When ready to harvest, sugarcane can be twice the height of a grown man.

The sweet sap extracted from this stem is dried to make cane sugar.

Drought-tolerant cereals are an important source of food in Africa.



Sorghum grains



Crystals of sugar

Sorghum

Oats are usually crushed and made into porridge.

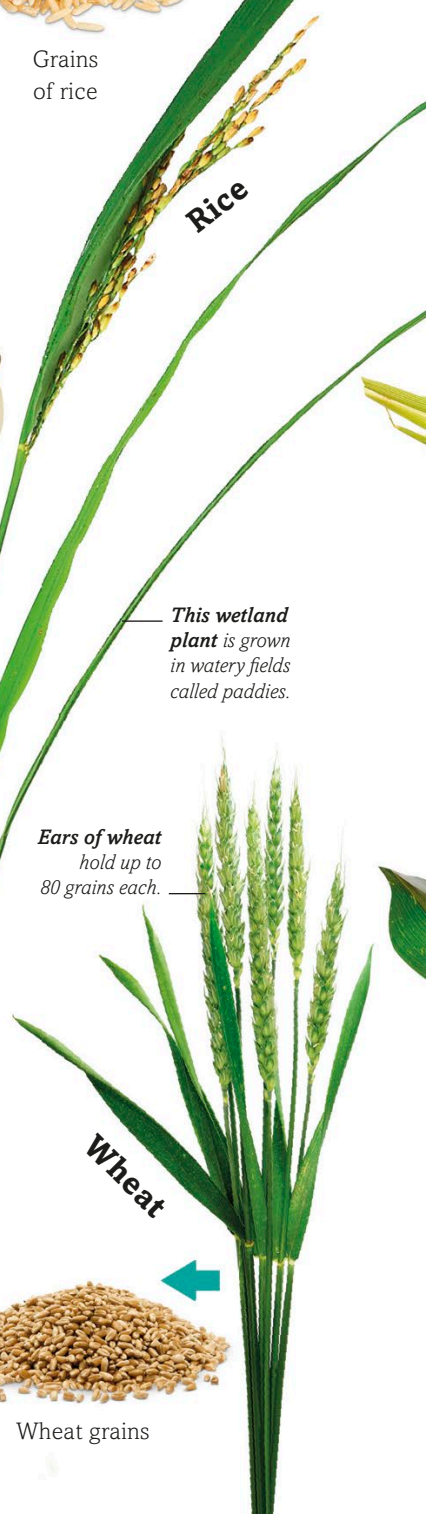


Oat grains

Oat



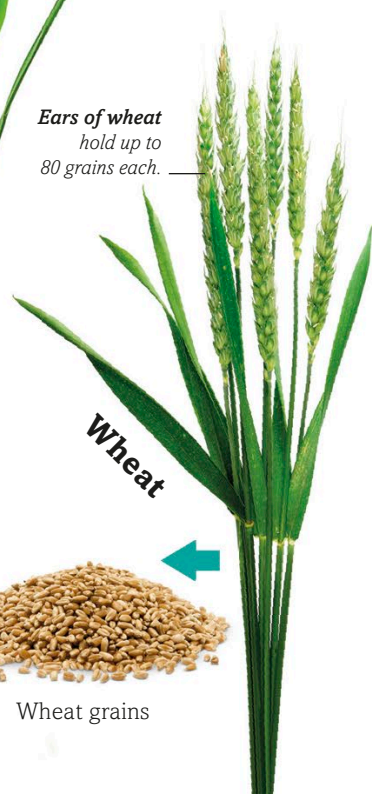
Grains of rice



Rice

This wetland plant is grown in watery fields called paddies.

Ears of wheat hold up to 80 grains each.



Wheat



Wheat grains